25901171 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG4DSECOM202 - SOCIAL AND RURAL MARKETING

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

Very Short Answer Questions (Word/Phrase/Sentence)

Answer any **10** questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. _____ environment refers to the factors within the company that can be directly managed or controlled. [U] / [CO1]
2. What is the definition of positioning when applied to social marketing? [U] / [CO2]
3. What is concentrated targeting in a rural market? [U] / [CO3]
4. Describe how e-rural markets connect producers and consumers. [U] / [CO4]
5. State two promotional tools used in Social Marketing campaigns. [U] / [CO1]
6. Define Social Marketing. [U] / [CO1]
7. How does education function as a social marketing tool for NGOs? [U] / [CO2]
8. Define a rural product. [U] / [CO3]
9. What is meant by promotion mix in rural marketing? [U] / [CO3]
10. Identify one factor related to infrastructure that affects rural pricing. [U] / [CO3]

11. What is medicare services? [U] / [CO2]

12. What is meant by product adaptation in rural consumer durable marketing? [U] / [CO4]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B

Short Essay Questions

Answer any **5** questions

Each question carries **8** marks

13. Describe targeting in rural marketing and its significance. [U] / [CO3]

14. Evaluate how digital communication has transformed promotional strategies in rural banking and telecom sectors. [U] / [CO4]

15. What is the focus of NGOs in maternal healthcare? [U] / [CO2]

16. Distinguish between commercial and social marketing. [U] / [CO1]

17. What are the common bases used to segment a social marketing audience? [U] / [CO2]

18. Discuss the challenges faced by firms in developing and pricing rural products. [U] / [CO3]

19. Describe 4 Ps in Social Marketing. [U] / [CO1]

[8x5 = 40]

Part C

Essay Questions- Case or Situation Type

Answer any **1** questions

Each question carries **20** marks

20. [An] / [CO2]

A national bottled water brand launched a Cause-Related Marketing (CRM) campaign titled “Clean Water for Communities.” Under this initiative, the company pledged to donate ₹5 from every bottle sold to support safe drinking water projects in rural villages. The brand partnered with a reputed NGO to install water purification units and conduct hygiene awareness programs. The campaign was promoted through television advertisements, social media, and in-store displays highlighting how each purchase would help provide clean water.

Customers responded positively, leading to increased sales and greater visibility for the cause. The NGO implemented the projects on the ground, monitored fund utilization, and shared impact reports with the company. However, some consumers questioned how much money actually reached the beneficiaries, while others felt such campaigns should be long-term initiatives rather than short promotional activities.

You are required to:
(a) Identify the social issue addressed in this case.
(b) Explain how Cause-Related Marketing (CRM) is applied in this campaign.
(c) Discuss the scope of CRM as reflected in this case (mention at least two areas).
(d) Identify the type of Cause-Related Marketing used here and justify your answer.
(e) State any two challenges of Cause-Related Marketing highlighted in this case.

21. PurpleLilly Ltd. is a rural agricultural marketing company engaged in the cultivation and marketing of ornamental and commercial flowers in Munnar, Kerala, India. The company procures flowers from local cultivators and markets them across South India, particularly exporting fresh flowers to Tamil Nadu. [An] / [CO4]
In recent years, the company has observed the following developments:

- Rising demand for ornamental flowers in domestic and regional markets due to increased use in decoration, events, and religious purposes.
- Government initiatives promoting floriculture and supporting women's rural entrepreneurship, leading to increased participation in flower cultivation.
- Growing adoption of greenhouse cultivation and modern farming techniques to improve flower quality and productivity.
- Expansion of online flower delivery platforms and increasing use of digital payment systems.

Despite these opportunities, the company faces several challenges, including the short shelf life of flowers, seasonal fluctuations in demand, transportation delays, and lack of standardized grading and packaging practices.
To enhance its market position, PurpleLilly Ltd. plans to establish cold storage facilities in different parts of Kerala and Tamil Nadu, improve packaging and preservation methods, develop strong branding strategies through celebrity endorsements, and create direct market linkages with buyers to reduce intermediaries.

1. Identify and explain the growth opportunities available for PurpleLilly Ltd. in the floriculture market. (8 Marks)
2. Analyse the major challenges faced by PurpleLilly Ltd. in marketing and distribution of flowers. (6 Marks)
3. Suggest suitable strategies to improve supply chain efficiency and strengthen market position of PurpleLilly Ltd. (6 Marks)

[20x1 = 20]